

DICENTRA

D. cucullaria (Dutchman’s breeches) illus. p.348.
D. eximia of gardens. See *D. formosa*.
D. formosa, syn. *D. eximia* of gardens. Spreading, tufted perennial. H 18in (45cm), S 1ft (30cm). In late spring and early summer, bears slender, arching sprays of pendent, heart-shaped, pink or dull red flowers above ovate, finely cut, gray-green leaves. Z4–8
D. peregrina. Tuft-forming perennial. H 3in (8cm), S to 2in (5cm). Locket-shaped, pink flowers are borne in early summer, above fernlike, blue-green leaves. Needs gritty soil. Suitable for an alpine house. Z4–8
D. spectabilis. See *Lamprocapnos spectabilis*.
D. ‘Spring Morning’ illus. p.256.
D. ‘Stuart Boothman’ illus. p.268.

DICHELOSTEMMA

ASPAGACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering corms, grown for their dense flower heads. Related to *Brodiaea* and similar to *Allium* in appearance. Where marginally hardy, best grown in a sheltered site. Needs a sunny position and well-drained soil. Water freely in spring, but allow to dry out after flowering. Propagate by seed in fall or spring, or by offsets in fall before growth commences.
D. capitatum, syn. *Brodiaea capitata*, *B. pulchella*, *Dichelostemma pulchellum*. Early summer-flowering corm. H 12–24in (30–60cm), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Long, narrow leaves are semierect and basal. Slender, leafless stem bears a dense head of narrowly funnel-shaped, pale to deep violet flowers, ½–¾in (1–2cm) long, with violet bracts. Z9–11
D. congestum, syn. *Brodiaea congesta*, illus. p.392.
D. ida-maia, syn. *Brodiaea ida-maia*. Early summer-flowering corm. H to 3ft (1m), S 3–4in (8–10cm). Long, narrow leaves are semierect and basal. Leafless stem bears a dense head of flowers, each ¾–1in (2–2.5cm) long, with a red tube and 6 green petals. Z5–8
D. pulchellum. See *D. capitatum*.

DICHORISANDRA

COMMELINACEAE

Genus of erect, clump-forming, evergreen perennials, grown for their ornamental foliage. Frost tender. Prefers fertile, moist but well-drained soil, humid conditions and partial shade. Propagate by division in spring or by stem cuttings in summer.
D. reginae illus. p.473.

Dichromena colorata. See *Rhynchospora colorata*.

DICKSONIA

DICKSONIACEAE

Genus of evergreen or semievergreen, treelike ferns that resemble palms and that are sometimes used to provide height in fern plantings. Needs semishade and humus-rich, moist soil. Remove faded fronds regularly. Propagate by spores in summer.
D. antarctica (Australian tree fern) illus. p.290.

D. fibrosa. Evergreen, treelike fern (deciduous in cold climates). H to 20ft (6m), S to 12ft (4m). Sturdy trunks are crowned by a rosette of spreading, lance-shaped, dark green, divided fronds, to 6ft (2m) long. Z9–10
D. squarrosa. Evergreen, treelike fern (deciduous in cold climates). H to 20ft (6m), S to 12ft (4m). Slender trunks are crowned by a rosette of spreading, divided, lance-shaped, mid-green fronds, to 6ft (2m) long, with blackish stalks and midribs. Z9–10

DICTAMNUS

RUTACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering perennials. Requires full sun and fertile, well-drained soil. Resents disturbance. Propagate by seed sown in late summer when fresh. ☉ The foliage, roots and seeds of *D. albus* may cause mild stomach upset if ingested, and contact with the foliage may cause photodermatitis.
D. albus var. **albus** (Burning bush) illus. p.230. var. **purpureus** (syn. *D. fraxinella*) is an upright perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 2ft (60cm). Has light green leaves divided into ovate leaflets. In early summer, bears spikes of fragrant, star-shaped, purplish-pink flowers with long stamens. Z3–8
D. fraxinella. See *D. albus* var. *purpureus*.

Didiscus coeruleus. See *Trachymene coerulea*.

DIDYMOCHLAENA

DRYOPTERIDACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen fern. Frost tender. Has tufts of glossy, mid-green fronds, tinged with rose-pink or red when young. Need partial shade, high humidity and moist, humus-rich soil. Propagate by spores as soon as ripe, or divide in spring.
D. lunulata. See *D. truncatula*.
D. truncatula, syn. *D. lunulata*. Evergreen fern. H and S to 3ft (1m). Erect rhizomes bear triangular, divided fronds, 2–5ft (60cm–1.5m) long, with simple diamond-shaped segments. Z9–11 (min. 50°F/10°C)

DIEFFENBACHIA

Dumb cane, Leopard lily

ARACEAE

Genus of evergreen, tufted perennials, grown for their large, handsome leaves. Frost tender. Needs partial shade and fertile, well-drained soil. Propagate by leafless pieces of stem placed horizontally in compost, or by stem cuttings, in spring or summer. Scale insect or red spider mite can be troublesome. ☉ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested; contact with sap may irritate skin.
D. amoena of gardens. See *D. seguine* ‘Amoena’.
D. ‘Exotica’. See *D. seguine* ‘Exotica’.
D. maculata ‘Exotica’. See *D. seguine* ‘Exotica’.
‘Rudolph Roehrs’ see *D. seguine* ‘Rudolph Roehrs’.
D. ‘Memoria’. See *D. seguine* ‘Memoria Corsii’.
D. seguine. Evergreen, tufted perennial. H and S 3ft (1m) or more. Broadly lance-shaped leaves, to 18in (45cm) long, are glossy and dark green. Insignificant, tiny, greenish-white flowers, clustered on

the spadix, are surrounded by a narrow, leaflike spathe that is produced intermittently. Z14–15. (min. 59°F/15°C)
‘Amoena’ (syn. *D. amoena* of gardens), H to 6ft (2m), is robust, with creamy-white bars along lateral veins on the leaves. **‘Exotica’** (syn. *D. ‘Exotica’*, *D. maculata* ‘Exotica’) illus. p.465. **‘Memoria Corsii’** (syn. *D. ‘Memoria’*) has gray-green leaves, marked dark green and spotted white. **‘Rudolph Roehrs’** (syn. *D. maculata* ‘Rudolph Roehrs’, *D.s.* ‘Roehrs’) illus. p.474.

DIERAMA

Angel’s fishing rod, Wandflower

IRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen, clump-forming, summer-flowering corms with pendent, funnel- or bell-shaped flowers on long, arching, wiry stems. Thrives near ponds. Prefers a warm, sunny, sheltered site and well-drained soil that is moist during summer growth. Dies down partially in winter. Propagate by division of corms in spring or by seed in fall or spring. Resents disturbance; divisions take a year or more to flower.
D. dracomontanum, syn. *D. pumilum*. Vigorous, evergreen, upright perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm). In summer, freely produces nodding, funnel-shaped flowers, in shades of pink and violet, on wiry stems. Leaves are grasslike. Z8–9
D. ensifolium. See *D. pendulum*.
D. igneum. Clump-forming, cormous perennial. H to 3ft (1m), S 20in (50cm). In summer, bears long, pendulous spikes with 4–11 bell-shaped, lilac to rosy pink flowers per branch. Has narrow, linear leaves. Z6–10
D. pendulum, syn. *D. ensifolium* (Angel’s fishing rod), illus. p.392.
D. pulcherrimum illus. p.386.
D. pumilum. See *D. dracomontanum*.

DIERVILLA

CAPRIFOLIACEAE

Genus of deciduous, summer-flowering shrubs. Similar to *Weigela*. Needs partial shade or full sun and well-drained, moderately fertile soil. To keep neat, remove 2- and 3-year-old stems in winter or after flowering. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in late summer or hardwood cuttings in fall.
D. sessilifolia. Deciduous, spreading shrub. H and S 3–5ft (1–1.5m). Narrowly ovate, pointed, serrated, green leaves are often copper-tinted when young. Bears terminal and lateral clusters of tubular, pale yellow flowers in summer. To treat as a herbaceous perennial, cut back to ground level each spring and apply mulch and fertilizer. Z4–8

DIETES

IRIDACEAE

Genus of evergreen, irislike, rhizomatous perennials, grown for their attractive flowers borne in spring or summer. Needs sun or partial shade and humus-rich, well-drained soil that does not dry out excessively. Propagate by seed in fall or spring, or by division in spring (although divisions do not become re-established very readily).

D. bicolor illus. p.395.
D. iridioides, syn. *D. vegeta* of gardens. Evergreen, spring- and summer-flowering, rhizomatous perennial. H to 2ft (60cm), S 1–2ft (30–60cm). Has sword-shaped, semierect, basal leaves in a spreading fan. Branching, wiry stems bear irislike, white flowers, 2½–3in (6–8cm) across; the 3 large petals each have a central, yellow mark. Z8–11
D. vegeta of gardens. See *D. iridioides*.

DIGITALIS

Foxglove

PLANTAGINACEAE

Genus of biennials, perennials and shrubs, grown for their imposing flower spikes, borne in summer. Species mentioned below grow in most conditions, even dry, exposed sites, but do best in semishade and moist but well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in fall. ☉ All parts may cause severe discomfort if ingested. Contact with foliage may irritate skin.
D. ambigua. See *D. grandiflora*.
D. canariensis, syn. *Isoplexis canariensis*, illus. p.459.
D. eriostachya. See *D. lutea*.
D. ferruginea. Perennial best treated as a biennial. H 3–4ft (1–1.2m), S 1ft (30cm). Long, slender spikes bear funnel-shaped, orange-brown and white flowers in midsummer above basal rosettes of ovate, rough leaves. Z4–9
D. grandiflora, syn. *D. ambigua* (Yellow foxglove). Evergreen, clump-forming perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm). In summer, bears racemes of downward-pointing, tubular, creamy-yellow flowers above a rosette of ovate to oblong, smooth, strongly veined leaves. Z3–8
D. lutea, syn. *D. eriostachya*. Upright perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm). In summer, delicate spires of downward-pointing, narrowly tubular, creamy-yellow flowers are borne above a rosette of ovate, smooth, mid-green leaves. Z3–8
D. x mertonensis. Clump-forming perennial. H 30in (75cm), S 1ft (30cm). Produces spikes of downward-pointing, tubular, rose-mauve to coppery flowers in summer, above a rosette of ovate, hairy, soft leaves. Divide after flowering. Z3–8
D. purpurea. Upright, short-lived perennial, grown as a biennial. H 3–5ft (1–1.5m), S 2ft (60cm). Has a rosette of ovate, rough, deep green leaves and, in summer, tall spikes of tubular flowers in shades of pink, red, purple or white. Z4–8.
f. albiflora (syn. *D.p. f. alba*) illus. p.299. **‘Pam’s Choice’** has white flowers, stained deep red in the throat. **‘Sutton’s Apricot’** has apricot-pink flowers.
D. x valinii. Rosette-forming or low-branching, short-lived perennial. H 3ft (1m), S 20in (50cm). Has ovate, hairy leaves and, in summer, bears dense racemes of horizontally-held, tubular flowers in shades of pink and orange, paler in the throat. Sterile and produces no pollen. Prone to winter rot and often best grown as an annual. Z6–10. **ILLUMINATION APRICOT** (**‘Chelsea Gold’**) has orange flowers, pinkish in bud, with a creamy throat. **ILLUMINATION PINK** (**‘Tmdgfp001’**) has bright pink flowers, orange shading to cream in the throat.